

PSYCHOLOGICAL SAFETY

Psychological safety is not comfort.

How to get people to say what they actually think.

AND THE CONSEQUENCE

It is being able to disagree without paying for it afterward.

THE CASCADE

The invitation nobody accepts.

WHAT YOU SEE

You open the meeting with feel free to speak up...

THE MECHANISM

...and you get polite silence, with everyone agreeing...

THE CONSEQUENCE

...because the real conversation already happened in the hallway.

The invitation is worthless next to the track record. The team remembers the record.

THE FORK

What your team already learned about speaking.

WHAT THEY LEARNED

01

Nobody has disagreed in three months?
That is not consensus.

02

Bad news always arrives late? That is fear.

03

Someone corrects you in front of others?
Then you have it.

A comfortable team agrees. A safe team argues and decides.

THE METHOD

The scoreboard of the last person who spoke.



01 YOUR FIRST REACTION

the first seconds, and everyone was watching them

02 WHERE THE IDEA WENT

it became action, or it died there with no follow up

03 WHO TOOK THE CREDIT

if you took the idea as yours, the scoreboard reset

04 THE COST AFTERWARD

a black mark, cold shoulder or a line in the review

The team updates that scoreboard on its own, without you knowing, every episode.

IN PRACTICE, IN ORDER

The reaction that keeps the door open.

01 • YOUR FIRST
REACTION

Do not answer on the spot.

the automatic defense is what closes the conversation for good

02 • WHERE THE
IDEA WENT

Ask what else you have seen.

shows real interest and brings out the rest she was holding back

03 • WHO TOOK
THE CREDIT

Write it down in front of everyone.

noting it in public signals that it will become something

04 • THE COST
AFTERWARD

Come back with the outcome.

with no follow up, the next piece of information never arrives

TWO MODELS

A comfortable room or a safe room.

THE COMMON MODEL

Comfortable

Everyone agrees quickly

Nobody brings problems early

The meeting ends light

The real conversation is in the hallway

THE DESIGNED MODEL

Safe

Disagreement shows up with data

Problems arrive while they are small

The meeting ends with a decision

The real conversation is in the room

MISTAKE AND CONSEQUENCE

Three reactions that reset the scoreboard.

01 Answering by explaining why the criticism is wrong.

→ after two episodes, nobody brings anything again.

02 Listening and never coming back.

→ the person learns that speaking changes nothing, and saves the energy.

03 Bringing the episode up later, in another context.

→ that teaches the whole team that what you say is filed against you.

A person speaks once to test it. Your reaction decides whether there is a second time.

THE CHAIN

The dissenter test.

01

Think about the last important decision in your area.



02

Did anyone disagree out loud, in the room, with you present?



03

Nobody, in three months? That is not alignment, it is silence.



WHERE LEADERSHIP STEPS IN

Consensus that arrives too fast is usually the sound of a team that gave up speaking.

RUN IT THIS WAY NEXT TIME

Three moves to reopen the door.



STEP 01

Ask one specific person to point at the hole in your plan.

an open question to the group does not work, pick a person



STEP 02

Come back with what happened to the last idea you received.

even if it was discarded, say why



STEP 03

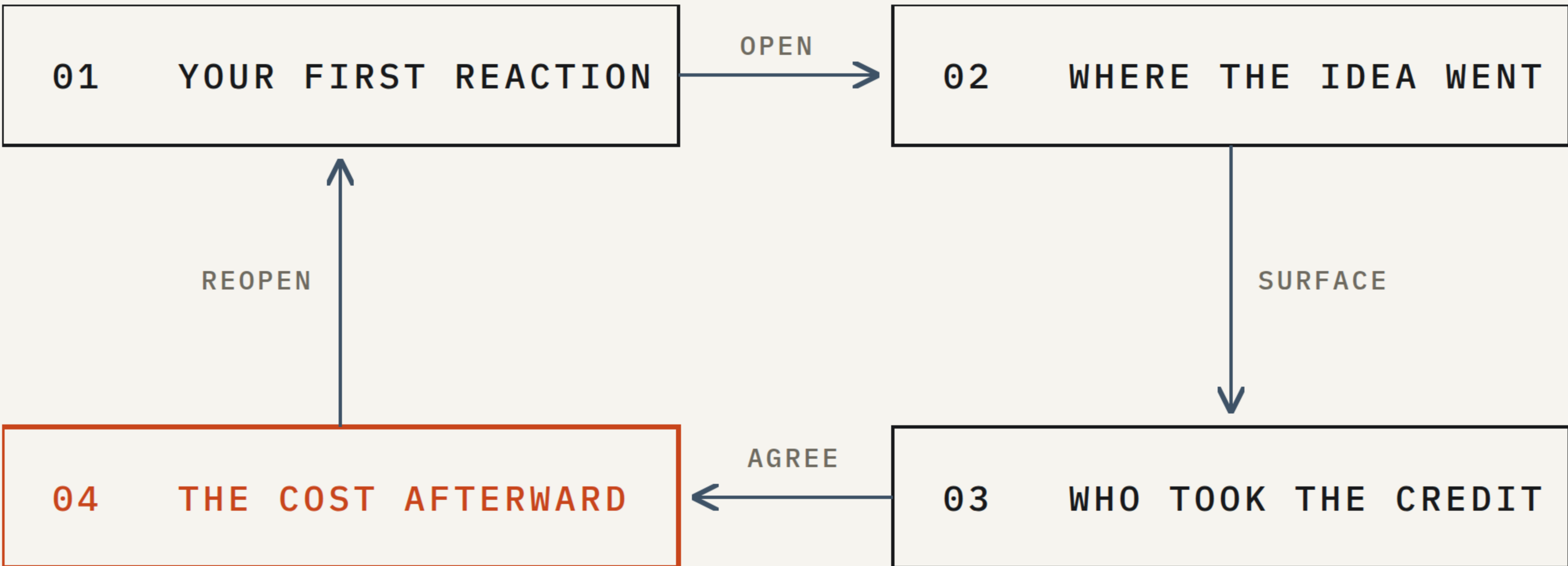
Give public credit to whoever corrected you.

one episode like that is worth ten speeches about openness

You do not ask for honest speech, you build a record that it is worth it.

THE MODEL THAT STICKS

The Scoreboard, a loop and not a list.



Nobody speaks because you invited them.
They speak because of what happened to
the last one.

SAVE THIS FOR LATER

next time someone contradicts you in a meeting.

FABIO GARCIA

MANAGEMENT AS ENGINEERING
/IN/FALERCIA